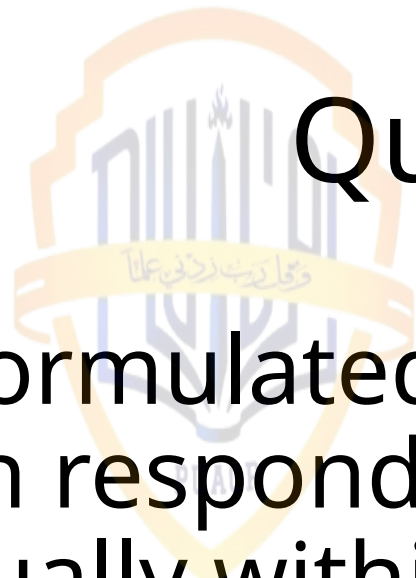




Administering questionnaires

Iqra Abdullah

Book Reference: Sekaran, Uma, and Roger Bougie. Research methods for business: A skill building approach. John Wiley & Sons, 2016.

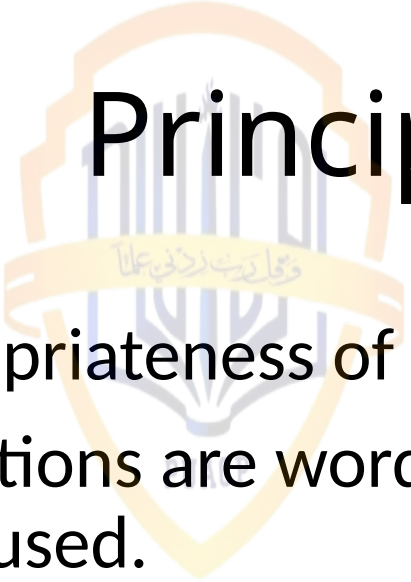


Questionnaire

A preformulated written set of questions to which respondents record their answers, usually within rather closely defined alternatives

- Personally administered questionnaire
- Mail questionnaire
- Electronic and online questionnaire

Mode of data collection	Advantages	Disadvantages
Personally administered questionnaires	Can establish rapport and motivate respondent. Doubts can be clarified. Less expensive when administered to groups of respondents. Almost 100% response rate ensured. Anonymity of respondent is high.	Explanations may introduce a bias. Take time and effort.
Mail questionnaires	Anonymity is high. Wide geographic regions can be reached. Token gifts can be enclosed to seek compliance. Respondent can take more time to respond at convenience. Can be administered electronically, if desired.	Response rate is almost always low. A 30% rate is quite acceptable. Cannot clarify questions. Follow-up procedures for nonresponses are necessary.
Electronic questionnaires	Easy to administer. Can reach globally. Very inexpensive. Fast delivery. Respondents can answer at their convenience like the mail questionnaire. Automatic processing of answers.	Computer literacy is a must. Sampling issues. High non-response. Not always possible to generalize findings. Respondent must be willing to complete the survey. People find invitations via email rude and offensive; emails are deleted or people complain.



Principles of Wording

1. The appropriateness of the content of the questions.
2. How questions are worded and the level of sophistication of the language used.
3. The type and form of questions asked.
4. The sequencing of the questions.
5. The personal data sought from the respondents.

Open-ended versus closed questions

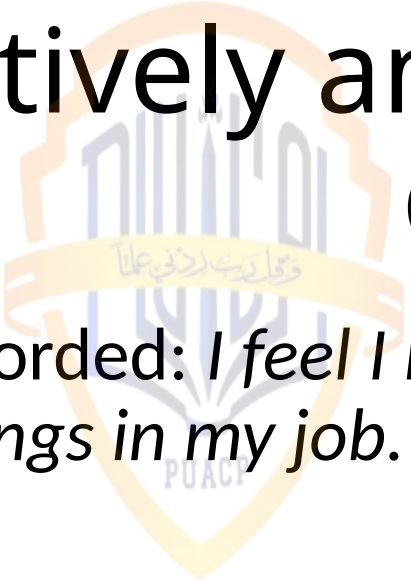
- **Open-ended questions:** allow respondents to answer them in any way they choose.

An example of an open-ended question is asking the respondent to state five things that are interesting and challenging in the job.

- **Closed-ended questions:** in contrast, asks the respondents to make choices among a set of alternatives given by the researcher.

For instance, instead of asking the respondent to state any five aspects of the job that she finds interesting and challenging, the researcher might list 10 or 15 aspects that might seem interesting or challenging in jobs and ask the respondents to rank the first five among these in the order of their preference.

Positively and negatively worded questions

The logo of the University of Al-Qadisiyah is positioned behind the title. It features a shield-like emblem with Arabic calligraphy and the acronym 'UQA'.

- Positively worded: *I feel I have been able to accomplish a number of different things in my job.*
- Negatively worded: *I do not feel I am very effective in my job.*

Double-Barrelled Questions

A question that lends itself to different possible responses to its subparts.

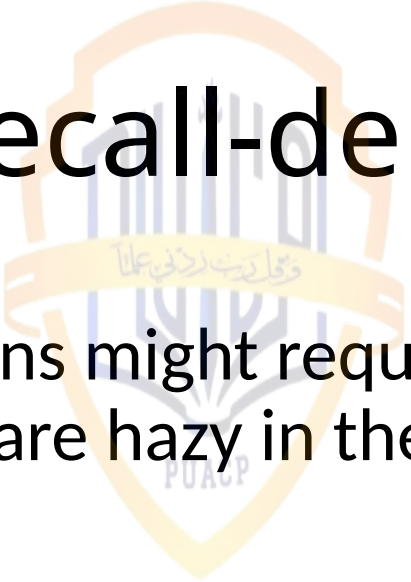
Example: Do you think there is a good market for the product and that it will sell well?

The logo of the Punjab University of Agriculture, Chokkistan (PUACP) is positioned in the background. It features a shield-like emblem with a yellow border. Inside the shield, there are stylized blue and white elements, possibly representing a book or a flame. A yellow banner across the middle of the shield contains Urdu text. Below the shield, the acronym 'PUACP' is visible in blue.

Ambiguous Questions

Questions that are not double-barrelled might be ambiguously worded and the respondent may not be sure what exactly they mean.

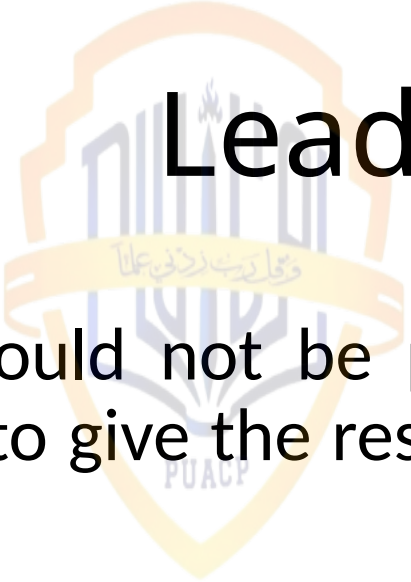
Example: “To what extent would you say you are happy?”



Recall-dependent questions

Some questions might require respondents to recall experiences from the past that are hazy in their memory.

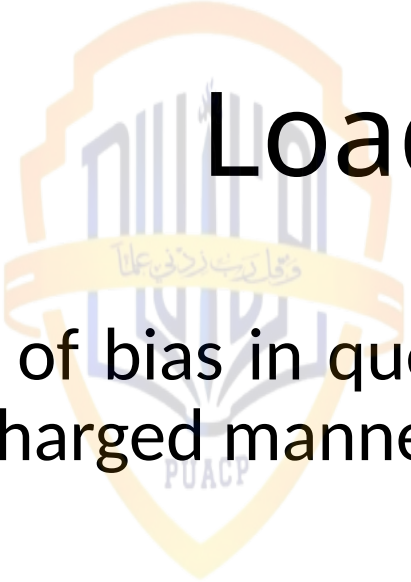
Example: if an employee who has had 30 years' service in the organization is asked to state when he first started working in a particular department and for how long?

The logo of the Punjab University of Agriculture, Cholistan (PUACP) is positioned in the background. It features a shield-like emblem with a yellow border. Inside the shield, there are blue and white geometric patterns. A yellow banner across the middle contains Urdu text. Below the banner, the acronym 'PUACP' is visible in blue.

Leading Questions

Questions should not be phrased in such a way that they lead the respondents to give the responses that the researcher would like them to give.

An example of such a question is: “Don’t you think that in these days of escalating costs of living, employees should be given good pay rises?”



Loaded Question

Another type of bias in questions occurs when they are phrased in an emotionally charged manner.

An example of such a loaded question is asking employees: “To what extent do you think management is likely to be vindictive if the union decides to go on strike?”

Socially Desirable Questions

Questions should not be worded such that they elicit socially desirable responses.

For instance, a question such as “Do you think that older people should be laid off?”

Other information to consider

- Length of questions
- Grouping and classification of questions
- Sequencing of questions

GETUP OF THE QUESTIONNAIRE!



Cover Letter

EXAMPLE

Dear Participant

Date

This questionnaire is designed to study aspects of life at work. The information you provide will help us better understand the quality of our work life. Because you are the one who can give us a correct picture of how you experience your work life, I request you to respond to the questions frankly and honestly.

Your response will be kept strictly confidential. Only members of the research team will have access to the information you give. In order to ensure the utmost privacy, we have provided an identification number for each participant. This number will be used by us only for follow-up procedures. The numbers, names, and the completed questionnaires will not be made available to anyone other than the research team. A summary of the results will be mailed to you after the data are analyzed.

Thank you very much for your time and cooperation. I greatly appreciate the help of your organization and yourself in furthering this research endeavor.

Cordially,
(Sd)

A. Professor, PhD

Organizing questions, giving instructions and guidance, and good alignment

Section Two: About Work Life

The questions below ask about how you experience your work life. Think in terms of your everyday experiences and accomplishments on the job and put the

most appropriate response number for you beside each item, using the scale below.

Strongly Agree	Agree	Slightly Agree	Neutral	Slightly Disagree	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
I do my work best when my job assignments are fairly difficult.						—
When I have a choice, I try to work in a group instead of by myself.						—
In my work assignments, I try to be my own boss.						—
I seek an active role in the leadership of a group.						—
I try very hard to improve on my past performance at work.						—
I pay a good deal of attention to the feelings of others at work.						—
I go my own way at work, regardless of the opinions of others.						—
I avoid trying to influence those around me to see things my way.						—
I take moderate risks, sticking my neck out to get ahead at work.						—
I prefer to do my own work, letting others do theirs.						—
I disregard rules and regulations that hamper my personal freedom.						—

Demographic or Personal Information

Section One: About Yourself

Please circle the numbers representing the most appropriate responses for you in respect of the following items.

1. Your age

- 1 Under 20
- 2 20-35
- 3 36-50
- 4 51-65
- 5 Over 65

2. Your highest completed level of education

- 1 Elementary school
- 2 High school
- 3 College degree
- 4 Graduate degree
- 5 Other (specify)

3. Your gender

- 1 Female
- 2 Male

4. Your marital status

- 1 Married
- 2 Single
- 3 Widowed
- 4 Divorced or separated
- 5 Other (specify)

5. Number of preschool children (under 5 years of age)

- 1 None
- 2 One
- 3 Two
- 4 Three or more

6. Age of the eldest child in your care (years)

- 1 Under 5
- 2 5-12
- 3 13-19
- 4 Over 19
- 5 Not applicable

7. Number of years worked in the organization

- 1 Less than 1
- 2 1-2
- 3 3-5
- 4 6-10
- 5 Over 10

10. Job status

- 1 Top management
- 2 Middle management
- 3 First-level supervisor
- 4 Nonmanagerial

8. Number of other organizations worked for before joining this organization

- 1 None
- 2 One
- 3 Two
- 4 Three
- 5 Four or more

9. Present work shift

- 1 First
- 2 Second
- 3 Third

Information on income and other sensitive personal data!

Because many people believe that income is a significant factor in explaining the type of career decisions individuals make, the following two questions are very important for this research. Like all other

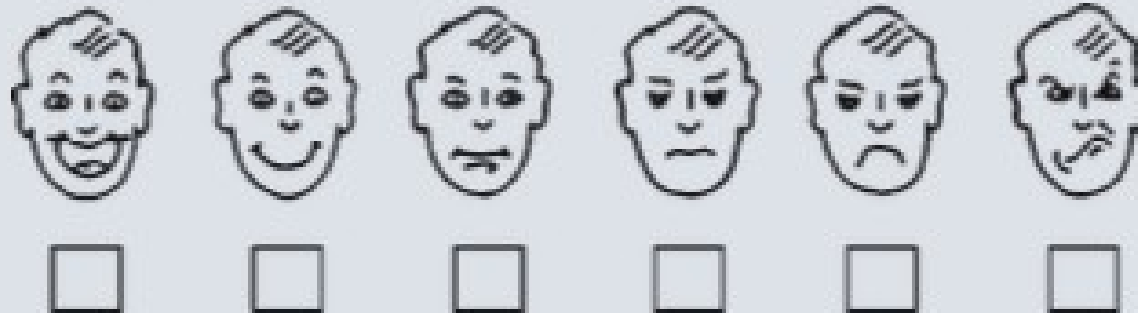
items in this questionnaire, the responses to these two questions will be kept confidential. Please circle the most appropriate number that describes your position.

Roughly, my total yearly income before taxes and other deductions is:	Roughly, the total yearly income before taxes and other deductions of my immediate family – including my own job income, income from other sources, and the income of my spouse – is:
1 Less than \$36 000	1 Less than \$36 000
2 \$36 000–50 000	2 \$36 000–50 000
3 \$50 001–70 000	3 \$50 001–70 000
4 \$70 001–90 000	4 \$70 001–90 000
5 Over \$90 000	5 \$90 001–120 000
	6 \$120 001–150 000
	7 Over \$150 000

Open-ended question at the end!

The questions in the survey may not be all-embracing and comprehensive and may not therefore have afforded you an opportunity to report some things you may want to say about your job, the organization, or yourself. Please make any additional comments needed in the space provided.

How did you feel about completing this questionnaire? Check the face in the following diagram that reflects your feelings.



Concluding the Questionnaire!



EXAMPLE

I sincerely appreciate your time and cooperation. Please check to make sure that you have not skipped any questions inadvertently, and then drop the ques-

tionnaire in the locked box, clearly marked for the purpose, at the entrance of your department.

Thank you!



Class Activity

Identify the variables and design a questionnaire that you could use to assess the quality of your on-campus dining facilities. Make sure you can test the following hypotheses:

H1: There is a positive relationship between the service quality of the on-campus dining facilities and customer loyalty.

H2: The relationship between service quality and customer loyalty is mediated by customer satisfaction.